

Nova Football Academy — Beginner Level

1. Understanding Football Basics

What is football?

Football is a team sport where two teams of 11 players compete to score more goals than their opponent. The game is based on three main ideas:

- Keeping possession of the ball
- Creating chances to score
- Preventing the opponent from scoring

A successful player understands that football is not only about technique, but also decision-making, teamwork, and intelligence.

2. The Basic Rules

The objective

The goal is simple:

- Put the ball into the opponent's goal
- Stop the opponent from scoring

Important rules:

Offside

A player is offside when they are closer to the opponent's goal than both:

- The ball
- The second-last defender

Offside prevents players from staying near the goal waiting for easy passes.

Fouls

A foul happens when a player:

- Pushes an opponent
 - Trips another player
 - Uses dangerous force
 - Handles the ball intentionally
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Yellow and Red Cards

 Yellow card:

- Warning for bad behavior or dangerous play

 Red card:

- Player is removed from the match
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3. Player Positions

Goalkeeper (GK)

Main responsibilities:

- Stop shots
- Organize defenders
- Start attacks

Important skills:

- Reflexes
 - Positioning
 - Communication
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Defender (CB)

Responsibilities:

- Stop attackers
- Win defensive duels
- Protect the goal

Important skills:

- Strength
 - Awareness
 - Tackling
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Fullback (RB/LB)

Modern fullbacks:

- Defend wide areas
- Support attacks
- Provide crosses

Examples:

- Overlapping runs
 - Creating width
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Midfielder

Midfielders connect defense and attack.

They must:

- Receive the ball
 - Pass accurately
 - Control the rhythm of the game
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Winger

Wingers:

- Attack from wide areas
- Beat defenders
- Create chances

Important skills:

- Speed
 - Dribbling
 - Crossing
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Striker

The striker's job:

- Score goals
- Create danger
- Press defenders

Important skills:

- Finishing
 - Movement
 - Positioning
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4. Basic Technical Skills

Passing

Types:

Short pass

Used to keep possession.

Long pass

Used to switch the play.

Through ball

A pass behind defenders into space.

First Touch

A player's first touch determines what happens next.

A good first touch:

- Controls the ball
 - Moves away from pressure
 - Creates options
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Dribbling

Good dribbling requires:

- Close control
- Body movement
- Timing

A player should not dribble just because they can. They should dribble when it creates an advantage.

5. Beginner Training Sessions

Session 1: Ball Control

Duration: 45 minutes

Warm-up:
10 minutes

Exercises:

- Ball touches
- Inside/outside touches
- Dribbling through cones

Focus:

Keeping the ball close.

Session 2: Passing

Exercises:

- Two-player passing
- One-touch passing
- Passing under pressure

Focus:

Accuracy > power

Session 3: Shooting

Exercises:

- Finishing from different angles
- Shooting after movement
- Weak foot practice